

Anita's Veg Café

A Data Story from Bengaluru

A passionate home cook turns her kitchen dreams into a thriving neighbourhood café — and now needs the power of data to understand her customers, grow her business, and build lasting loyalty.

SQL Analytics

Customer Behaviour

Loyalty Programs

Restaurant Business

THE ORIGIN STORY

From Home Kitchen to *Neighbourhood Icon*

At the start of 2021, Anita — a passionate home cook with years of perfecting South Indian and North Indian vegetarian recipes — made a bold decision: she would open her own café in the heart of Bengaluru.

What began as a small, unassuming venture quickly blossomed into something special. **Anita's Veg Café** found its audience almost immediately — young professionals seeking a quick, affordable lunch, college students craving comfort food between lectures, and vegetarian food lovers who were tired of compromising on flavour.

The secret to her early success was simplicity. Rather than overwhelming customers with a sprawling menu, Anita curated just three signature dishes — each prepared with the same care and consistency that made her home cooking legendary among friends and family.

Her **Paneer Butter Masala** became the go-to comfort order, rich and creamy with a silky tomato-based gravy. The **Veg Biryani** drew crowds at lunchtime with its fragrant, slow-cooked rice. And the **Masala Dosa**, a South Indian classic, sold steadily throughout the day — from breakfast rush to evening snack.

The Café at a Glance

2021

Year the café opened its doors in Bengaluru, Karnataka

3

Signature dishes on the menu — each perfected over years of home cooking

₹120-180

Price range — intentionally affordable to serve students and professionals

2

THE PROBLEM

Running on Instinct Isn't *Enough Anymore*

As the café grew, Anita realised that gut feeling could only take her so far. She began tracking her sales and customer visits — but the raw data sitting in her records was telling her nothing on its own.

01

No Visibility Into Revenue

Anita had no clear picture of how much each customer was actually spending with her over time. Without this, she couldn't identify her most valuable patrons or understand the true worth of customer relationships.

02

Unclear Dish Popularity

While the Masala Dosa always seemed busy, Anita wasn't sure which dish was truly the most popular overall — or what each individual customer favoured most. This uncertainty made it hard to plan inventory and promotions effectively.

03

Loyalty Program Blind Spots

A handful of regulars suggested launching a loyalty program, and Anita agreed. But once it went live, she had no way to measure whether it was actually changing customer behaviour — or just rewarding people who would have returned anyway.

THE LOYALTY PROGRAM

Rewarding the Regulars

Who Make the *Café Thrive*

It was Anita's regulars — the same faces appearing week after week — who first floated the idea of a loyalty program. Inspired by their suggestion, she introduced a simple points-based system in early January 2021.

The concept was straightforward: customers who joined the program would earn points on every purchase. More points meant more rewards — and more reasons to keep coming back to the café.

To make the Paneer Butter Masala — her most labour-intensive and beloved dish — even more enticing, Anita offered a special incentive: **double points** for every order of it. On top of that, members would enjoy a bonus loyalty week right from their join date, earning double points on every item for their first full week.

The early members, Aarav and Meera, signed up at different times in January. But even with the program running, Anita couldn't answer basic questions: *When did their spending habits change? What was the first thing they ordered after joining? Are loyalty members actually spending more?* These unanswered questions are exactly what she needs help solving.

Loyalty Program Rules

HOW POINTS ARE EARNED

Standard Earning Rate

Every ₹1 spent = 10 points, on any item from the menu

Paneer Butter Masala Bonus

Double points on every Paneer Butter Masala order — 20 points per ₹1

First Loyalty Week Bonus

All items earn double points during the member's first 7 days after joining

THE ANALYTICAL MISSION

What Anita Needs to *Know*

As Anita's data consultant, your job is to dig into her café's sales records and answer the questions that her business instincts alone cannot. Using SQL, you'll uncover patterns in customer behaviour, decode the impact of the loyalty program, and hand Anita the insights she needs to grow.



Customer Spending Analysis

Determine how much each customer has spent in total, and how frequently they visit — building a foundation for

understanding who the café's most valuable customers really are.



Menu Popularity & Preferences

Identify which dish is most popular overall, and what each individual customer orders most — giving Anita the intelligence to personalise her service and plan her kitchen more efficiently.



First Order Patterns

Find out what each customer ordered first when they walked in, and what loyalty members ordered immediately after joining — revealing first impressions and the halo effect of the program.



Pre vs. Post Loyalty Behaviour

Compare what customers ordered — and how much they spent — before and after joining the loyalty program, so Anita can measure whether the program is genuinely changing behaviour.



Points Calculation

Accurately calculate the points balance for each customer using standard and double-point rules, including the first-week bonus for loyalty members — so the rewards system is fair, transparent, and motivating.



Business Growth Strategy

Translate all findings into actionable insights that Anita can use to refine her menu pricing, reward strategy, and customer engagement — turning data into a genuine competitive advantage for a small café.

Anita's Veg Café

SQL Project 1 — DoDS @NDMIT
Bengaluru, Karnataka · Est. 2021